

## MARQUEELIMOSDAVIDCOCHRANEEDIT

Travel Radio Australia and we're speaking with David Cochran who is the business development manager of a fantastic company called Marquis Limousines based in Sydney but they have cars all over Australia. David, welcome to the program. Thanks Geoff, good to be here.

We're here in London at the World Travel Market and you're letting the whole world know about Marquis Limousines and it's a fantastic service. Tell us about what you do in Sydney and virtually anywhere in Australia. Yeah well Geoff, we're actually in New Zealand as well and so we've got a great hold in in the region.

Sydney based as you said and operating cars, our own cars, in all the major cities throughout Australia and New Zealand. It's a fantastic service and we were just chatting before, we won't mention any names, but you take a whole wide range of people from just normal knockabout boys and girls right up to the international movie stars. Yeah correct, we look after people as I always say Mr and Mrs Smith who come to Australia and effectively are just coming for a once in a lifetime trip.

They simply need to get from the airport to their hotel and then go from there. Right through to a lot of household names, people of high profile, of high net worth, really anything you could imagine we've done it in the transport business. Yeah I can imagine and your headquarters is in Sydney and people coming into Kingsford Smith, you've got a fantastic services there.

Yeah correct, spend a lot of time down at the airport, a lot of regular customers who use us going back and forth to the airport, as well as a lot of tourism companies who use us to transport their guests, their people that they're sending to Australia. Like I said before, they may be attending Australia for just a once in a lifetime trip down under. And I suppose there's business travellers as well and not to people who want to just maybe have a car for a day and you can take them out to all sorts of places and I suppose your drivers know, very well informed.

Yeah we do a lot of private touring and we do that all around Australia and New Zealand and it is quite popular. Yes we interact with a lot of business people, a fair percentage of our day-to-day business are people who are basically Sydney based, Melbourne based, Adelaide based, wherever they are, who are travelling regularly and need to be able to get to and from the airport consistently, reliably, professionally. And what's your background? Well I'm talking to David Cochran, the business development manager from Marquee Limousines.

How did you come to be with this company? I was actually in the food industry for many years. I sold out of that business years ago, still wanted to do something. Someone mentioned it to me and I've always liked tourism myself.

I've always liked travel and I've always liked customer service and I think at this point in life it was an opportunity to do something a bit different and do something that was probably, that I missed

doing when I was younger. So I really enjoy the customer service side of the business, looking after people, particularly the tourists who are coming in and visiting Australia for the first time, but it's growing. It's grown from me simply starting and helping in the business through to me now looking after the business development.

Sydney is such a wonderful destination for people coming in from overseas. It's often the first place people come to in Australia. Tell us a bit about your hidden gems in Sydney that you'd recommend to people to go and see.

People love seeing the icons of course, but that's pretty easy to see in Sydney. The Harbour Bridge, the Opera House, they're in proximity to most of the big city hotels. We love getting people up to the northern beaches.

If they've got enough time to do that, we love getting them up there. There's some great beaches. It's very Australian, great pubs up there, great places to take them for lunch.

I know we're selling cars and transfers, but I do get them to get on the ferry and getting them out to Manly or getting them out to Watson's Bay is also a very popular option and we do send them out to Watson's Bay and occasionally pick them up with the cars to bring them back. My biggest hidden secret or special is I tell them, particularly the Americans, when they wake up early in the morning jet lagged, get out into the city. It's safe.

Go down to the Opera House at four or five in the morning. You'll be the only one down there and just enjoy it, lap it up. The beautiful sunrises across Sydney and the sunsets and the beautiful views in the Harbour are just unmatched.

It's fantastic. What about here at World Travel Market? We're here at the stand here. Tell us about the stand that we're on and how is that working out for you? The stand's been good.

There are some Kiwis on here as well. We're all one big family when we're away at an event like this. I think everyone is meeting a very broad cross-section.

It is World Travel Market. There are people from all around the world here, exhibitors and buyers. We're seeing people that we already know and underlining that relationship through to, of course, meeting new potential customers for the business.

We're all, I think, having a reasonably successful show. It's a wonderful event, isn't it, for people like yourselves to meet with the inbound tourism operators who want to send you clients en masse and all that kind of stuff. It really is worth it being here.

Yes, correct. It's a big market. There's a lot of great places to travel in the world, but I think Australia and New Zealand are on everyone's list, or so it seems when you talk to them.

We're just a very easy, a very popular product. The biggest hurdle is always getting to travel that

far. We'll leave that up to the airlines to sort out.

Yes, that's true. Now, we spoke about New Zealand. Tell us about the New Zealand experience and what people can do there when they fly in and you can pick them up at the airport? Yes, we do the same sort of service, pick them up at the airport, then get them to their city hotels.

Marquee itself looks after about 30 hotels through the region, Australia and New Zealand, so we have a lot of strong relationships with those hotels. New Zealand, again, is a spectacular place. I'm Australian, I love Australia, but New Zealand's a great place to travel.

There are tons of places over there, especially Queenstown, which is probably on every visitor's list when they go to New Zealand. I think it's spectacular, and I think it just is an easy place to go and travel to as well. What about some of the other cities in Australia? We're talking Melbourne, Brisbane, Adelaide, Perth, Darwin.

You can really look after them in all those places with marquee limousines. Yes, we can. All the major ports in Australia, we can service, and we do that currently.

We have a fleet of all European cars, Mercedes, BMW, Audi, of any size we can look after, specialised mainly in groups probably under about 16, but we do do groups of even up to a couple of hundred people. We can cater to any transport requirement in the country. David Cochran, the business development manager of Marquee Limousines Australia and New Zealand, how can people find out more about Marquee online? They simply go to our website, [marqueelimousines.com.au](http://marqueelimousines.com.au), and they will pick up all the information in regards to us.

They can also book that way as well. Marquee is, as we spell it, m-a-r-q-u-e-e limousines.com, and it's a fantastic service that you're providing for all the inbound tourists to Australia. David Cochran, thank you very much for being with us on the program.

Yes, thank you. Thanks for having me.